

DIOMH PHARMACY SHELVING SOP

AIM: To ensure the proper arrangement of drugs on the Pharmacy shelves to avoid medication errors while ensuring aesthetics.

-  Generally, drugs should be arranged to fill the shelves sufficiently as either under or over shelving will lead to medication error. A space of between 5-10cm from the first drug to the edge of the shelf should always be maintained.
-  All drugs are arranged based on their generic names whether using the **Pharmacological class** or the **ABC** method.
-  The FEFO method of inventory management should be adopted, while FIFO should only be considered when drugs have similar expiry dates but have issues like torn packs, poor turnover, old packs etc
-  Arrangement for tablets and syrups should follow the **drug pharmacological classes** as labeled on the shelf and even with this it should be done alphabetically.
-  Injections should be arranged based on the **ABC** classification as labelled. Infusions should follow this order.
-  Drugs should be arranged in an aesthetically pleasing manner with little spaces in-between drugs.
-  Once a drug is picked, the next drug should be moved forward to cover up the vacant space left behind.
-  Drugs with similar appearances (similar pack colour) should not be placed together.
-  All counting drugs should be returned to the shelf after counting or after each close of shift.
-  Drugs should be arranged in vertical stacks of not more than 5, while the horizontal shelving should be arranged in such a way that there is a uniform space between the drug and the edge of the shelf. In either case, the drug name should be visible.
-  No extra pack of drug should be put at the back of the shelf instead this should be sent to the top shelf labelled “STORE SHELF”.
-  Drugs must be removed from their nylon seals and arranged orderly and in cases where the packs can be cut to reveal the drug, this should be done neatly using a scissors to trim the corners.

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- 🇬🇧 Drugs arranged horizontal e.g. Antibiotic infusions like Ciprofloxacin infusion etc should be done with some space, between 5-10cm, from the edge of the shelf.
- 🇬🇧 Personal belongings including items that aren't drugs should not be placed on the shelves whether temporarily or permanently.
- 🇬🇧 Drugs with part of the pack content removed should be crossed with an "X" sign on top of the pack and thus drug should be exhausted before using the next one. Meaning there shouldn't be more than 2 packs crossed with an "X".
- 🇬🇧 Drugs should not be removed from their blister pack but should be cut out neatly with a scissors.
- 🇬🇧 Drugs in the fridge should be arranged such that they are visible and not placed behind each other.
- 🇬🇧 Placing of drugs on top of the refrigerator should be discouraged and when it is necessary to do this, it should be placed in such that it allows proper ventilation for the refrigerator.
- 🇬🇧 Food, water, and all other edibles should not be placed in the refrigerator where drugs are kept, the call room refrigerator should be used for this.
- 🇬🇧 Eating in the Pharmacy is not allowed. The canteen or call room can be used for this.
- 🇬🇧 As part of routine handover, every person being handed over to should demand that the shelf is put in order if he/she finds it not following this standard or be responsible for putting it in order.